

DATA CENTERS & THE SHARED GRID

Why are Maryland power bills going up?

Maryland shares one big power grid, **PJM**, with 13 states and D.C. When the grid’s costs rise, every family on it helps pay.

1



Data centers need huge amounts of power

These buildings run AI and the internet. Many new ones are planned across our grid region.

2



The grid pays to have enough power ready

PJM pays power plants in advance to be ready on the hottest and coldest days. More expected demand means higher prices.

3



Everyone on the grid splits the cost

Those costs are shared by utilities like BGE and Potomac Edison, and they show up on household bills.

What it costs to keep enough power ready across PJM, per year

Before the 2024 auction		~\$2 billion
After the 2024 auction		~\$15 billion
2026–27		\$16 billion+

PJM’s independent market watchdog found the jump came “**almost entirely**” from existing and planned data centers.

Maryland home electricity prices rose about **18%** in one year (Oct. 2024 to Oct. 2025).

What’s happening now

SEPTEMBER 2026

PJM has asked federal regulators to let it buy **6,831 megawatts** of extra power supply for 2028, with **15-year contracts**, to prepare for expected data center growth.

135.4 MW

Maryland’s share (BGE and Potomac Edison areas)

Up to \$562M

Added cost Maryland customers could face over 15 years*

0 of 7

Maryland data centers in the forecast with a signed utility deal

The risk: if those data centers are delayed or never built, families could pay for power nobody needed.

Maryland’s consumer advocate is asking to...

- Make data centers cover the power and grid costs they cause
- Have them use less power during peak times
- Protect current customers if projects fall through

KEY DATE

Oct. 21

Maryland utilities can report demand savings to PJM to cut this cost for current customers.

*Office of People’s Counsel estimate if PJM buys the full amount at the highest proposed price. Data centers aren’t the only reason bills rise; delivery charges and fuel costs matter too. Sources: Inside Climate News (Sept. 1, 2026); Maryland Office of People’s Counsel; PJM Independent Market Monitor